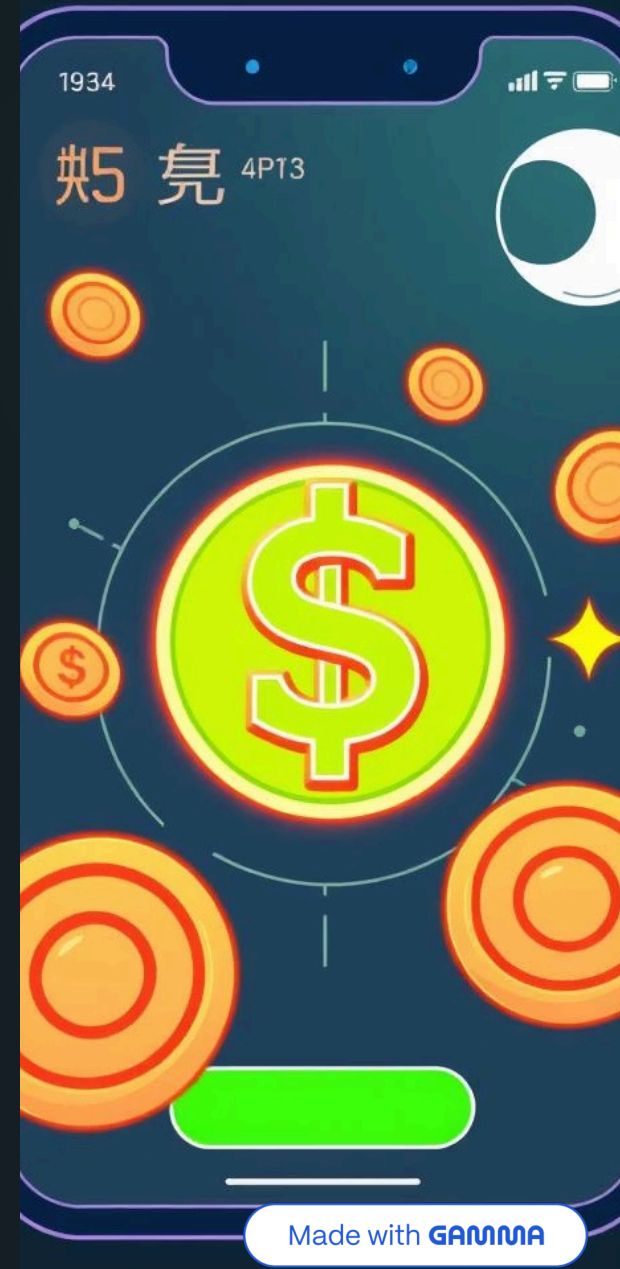


RMG Case Study

**Turn a curious first-time user
into a loyal daily player.**

By Rahul Ohri



Problem framing & definitions

A. Customer/segment definition

- Exactly how do we *define* "casual player" (quantitative rules)?
- Is this problem persistent across cohorts (older vs newer)?
- Do casuals differ by sport preference (cricket vs football vs kabaddi)?
- Are the churned casuals concentrated in particular geos / languages/states/gender/ age groups?
- What devices/OS versions do these users use? Any performance skew?

B. Problem scope & behaviour

- Are we measuring "churn" as uninstall, dormancy, or switch-to-competitor? (define exactly)
- Over what time window did the issue appear? Is it sudden (post-release) or gradual?
- Is the problem correlated with any product release or external event (campaign pause, season start, app update)?

C. Funnel & failure point hypotheses

- Which exact funnel step shows the biggest leakage right now? (signup, KYC, team creation, join contest, deposit, payout)
- Do we see different drop-off patterns by acquisition source (organic vs paid)?
- Are they dropping while doing a technical step (payments/verification) or a product step (team creation confusion)?
- Could a small UX change (copy, CTA, layout) cause the observed change?
- Is the leak early (before the first contest) or late (after the first contest/bad outcome)?

D. Competition & switching behaviour

- Do we have evidence users re-open Dream11/My11Circle, or is that an assumption?
- Are there competitors running aggressive promos at the same time?
- Are any competitors fixing a problem we have (e.g., faster payouts, better FTUE)?
- Do former users report why they left (support tickets, social posts, interviews)?

E. Motivation & psychology

- Are we delivering the *signal* of mastery (badges, leaderboards) and status (profile, public trophies)?
- Are we offering credible, low-risk experiences that satisfy FOMO or curiosity?
- Is the product failing to deliver emotional wins quickly enough?

F. Acquisition & campaigns

- Which UA channels feed the problematic cohorts? Are we acquiring the wrong audience?
- Are creatives or ad copy misleading about the experience (leading to expectation mismatch)?
- Are campaign targeting or lookalikes sending high-risk users (e.g., bots, mass signups)?

G. Technical & performance

- Any app crashes or long load times correlated with churn?
- Any server rate-limits / DB hiccups during peak match times?
- Are we missing events due to telemetry gaps that would blind us to the real leak?
- Are we seeing spikes in payment failures or refunds?

H. Measurement & validity

- How reliable is our instrumentation? Are key events missing or inconsistent?
- Are we measuring retention correctly (cohort-based, time-windowed)?
- Do we have guardrails for data skew (outliers, bots, QA users)?

Assumptions

For the purpose of this case study, we are making the following assumptions due to limited real-world data. These are designed to remove external noise and focus on **user behaviour and engagement** as the key levers for solving the problem:

1

User Type

- All users considered are **new/first-time players** on our platform.
- They have prior exposure to fantasy cricket via Dream11 or My11Circle.

2

Sport Focus

- Users are playing **cricket**, as both Dream11 and My11Circle are running promotions for cricket during the period of observation.

3

Churn Pattern

- Users are churning to **re-open and play on Dream11/My11Circle** after trying our app (not uninstalling entirely).

4

Product & Feature Parity

- Our platform is **at par** with Dream11/My11Circle in terms of gameplay formats, contest types, rewards, and payout structures.
- Entry fees, rake, and prize pool sizes are **comparable**.

5

Acquisition Channel Consistency

- All users in this analysis come from **paid performance marketing campaigns**, using consistent creatives and targeting.

6

Timeframe of Analysis

- Retention is measured over the **first 7 days post-install**, focusing on early habit formation.

7

Demographic Uniformity

- Cohort is predominantly **male, aged 18-35, from Tier 2-3 cities**, aligning with the core fantasy cricket audience.

8

Regulatory Stability

- No legal restrictions, regional bans, or payment gateway disruptions occurred during the observation period.

9

Operational Parity

- Real-time player stats, match data, and team announcements are delivered with **no delays**, matching competitor standards.
- Deposit and withdrawal success rates are **on par** with competitors, with no significant payment friction.

10

Incentive Parity

- First-time deposit bonuses, cashback offers, and promotional incentives are **comparable** to competitor offerings.

11

No External Disruptions

- No major product releases, app updates, server downtime, or seasonal effects (e.g., IPL start/end) are impacting user behaviour during the period analyzed.

User Persona: "Arjun-The Casual Matchday Player"

Snapshot:

Arjun is a 21-28-year-old Android user who plays fantasy cricket to kill time during commutes and tea/smoke breaks. He wants quick wins with minimal effort, loves freebies, and is easily pulled back to incumbents (Dream11/My11) unless your app gives him a faster, simpler, social, and confidence-building experience.

1

1) Demographics & device

- Age:** 18-35 (primary 21-28)
- Gender:** Male (core segment for this persona)
- Location:** India, Tier 2-3 cities (urban commuters, college towns)
- Device:** Android (low-mid range devices common)
- Connectivity:** Variable mobile data (prefers low-data experiences)
- Occupation:** College student / early-career professional (commute-heavy routine)

2

2) Behavioural & usage patterns

- New/first-time player** (signed up within 7 days) and **played <2 contests**
- Session pattern:** Short sessions (5-20 mins), often during commute, chai breaks, or between classes/work.
- Play frequency goal:** Casual/occasional initially (wants to become daily only if friction is low and reward is visible).
- Spending propensity:** Low to moderate; prefers micro-stakes (₹5-₹50) and freebies; may deposit small amounts if confident.
- Decision style:** Low-effort decision-maker- prefers templates, smart suggestions, and one-tap flows.
- Social:** Likes playing with friends but may not proactively create groups; will join if invited.
- Knowledge:** Not a cricket expert- few player details; low interest in pitch/weather analytics.
- Information sources:** Short-form video (YouTube shorts, Reels), influencers, friends' referrals.

3

3) Motivations & goals

- Primary motivation:** Pass time and enjoy matchday thrill with minimal effort required.
- Secondary motivations:** Earn small passive income, collect freebies or rewards, feel FOMO for offers/limited prizes, get social bragging rights among friends.
- Emotional jobs:** Want quick gratification, feel smart without heavy effort, and avoid looking foolish for bad picks.
- Success definition:** "I made a decent team fast and won something without spending much time."

4

4) What delights Arjun

- One-tap "Quick-Join" micro contests** with a Smart Pick (recommended team + captain) - fast path to first contest.
- First-time freebies / guaranteed small-win experience** (e.g., "first micro-contest free" or first-try cashback).
- Progress even when **losing**
- Low Effort** Team Creation : templates, expert team etc
- Simple, visual UI:** "pick-for-me" options, clear CTAs.
- Social invites & friend pools** easy join via link + friendly leaderboard.
- Short, contextual coaching** quick hero tips like "pick a captain with the best recent form."
- Visible small achievements & shareable cards** (post-win share to WhatsApp/FB) to show status.
- Low-data mode & compact UX** for commuting use.

5

5) Empathy map

- Says:** "I don't have time to study players. Give me a winning team fast."
- Thinks:** "I want to win something small without much effort."
- Does:** Opens app during short breaks, checks Smart Pick, joins micro-contests if the flow is 1-2 taps.
- Feels:** Curious, risk-averse, likes freebies, enjoys social bragging.

User Journey /Match Day Ritual

1

Sign up

- Quick skim of store page → taps "Install" if promo/bonus visible (free entry, sign-up bonus).
- Completes signup fast using OTP; skips optional fields (no profile bio).
- Immediately checks "How do I get freebies?" expects an obvious onboarding reward callout.

2

Match discovery

- Glances at "Today's matches" carousel while commuting or between tasks; chooses matches with familiar teams/players.
- Prefers short, clear labels: "T20, 2 hr, Easy" avoids matches that look complicated.
- If notified about trending or influencer-backed matches (e.g., Dhoni's squad), he swipes in immediately.

3

Contest discovery

- Filters for "Quick" / "Low entry" / "Free" contests; looks for contests with instant payout or fast results.
- Relies on social proof: joins contests with lots of participants or "popular right now" badges.
- Prefers single-click entry (one-screen checkout) and sees upfront prize vs. entry fee comparison.

4

Team selection

- Uses "Copy Team / Expert Team to save time.
- Scans the recommended list, taps to swap 1-2 favourites; won't deep-dive into stats.
- Picks a safe, well-known captain (or the app's confidence pick) wants confidence without research.
- Appreciates a 1-line rationale ("Captain: Virat- high form today") rather than long stats.

5

Payment

- Expects fast, familiar rails (UPI / saved card/wallet) and minimal screens.
- Look for small incentives: "Pay ₹10, get ₹5 back" or first-time payment cashback.
- If payment friction exists, he abandons and reverts to incumbents so visible trust signals (PG logos, instant success screen) matter.

6

Result / Rewards

- Immediately checks results notification and shares wins with friends (screenshot or share button).
- Wants instant, clear feedback: "You won ₹X withdraw now / use for next contest."
- If he loses, he expects small consolation (free entry, bonus moves, or streak progress) to keep him coming back.

Frictions & pain points

1

Irrelevant notifications: noisy pushes that aren't timed or actionable. Arjun is interested in Indian team cricket or IPL, but gets notifications for women's cricket matches, which he has no clue about

2

Not enough delight factors: Loss of contest means money lost, there's no delight only in participation

3

Loyalty not rewarded: Only winners are getting rewarded; no one is getting rewarded for participating every day. (even if it's there, it's not highlighted enough (DreamCoins))

4

Not enough offers: Favored payment method never has offers. For example, Arjun is a Google Pay user, but offers are always using BHIM UPI

5

No personalization: Favorite team or player matches are not highlighted

6

High stakes: reluctant to deposit larger amounts..

7

Too many steps to join a contest (team creation takes too long).

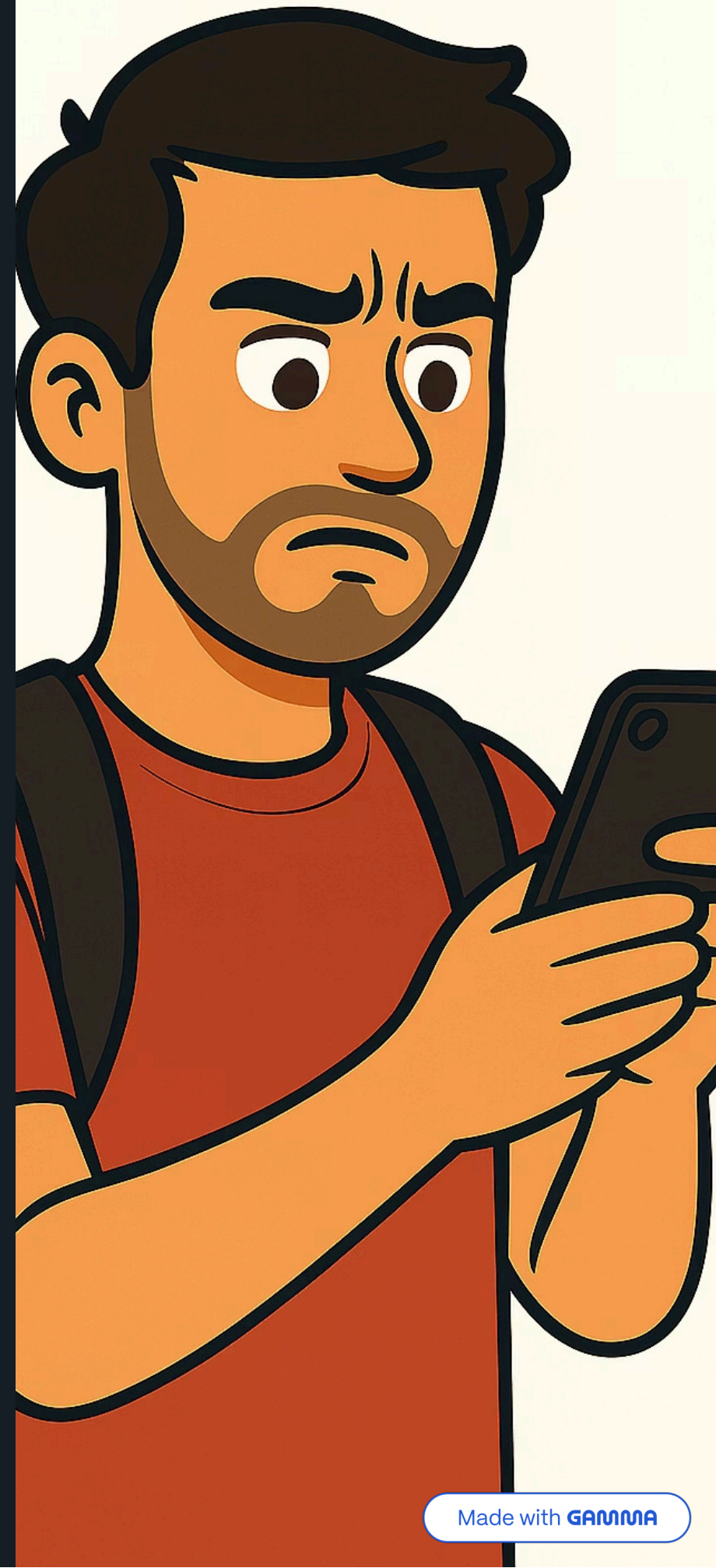
8

Information overload: doesn't know players; detailed stats are noise, not value.

9

Virtual Currency earned not highlighted:

Even if Arjun is earning virtual currency for taking part in contests, he doesn't know how much he earned for the same



Micros Deliverables:

High-level approach for forming habits



Make returning trivial & rewarding:

Clearly visible progress + simple daily asks.



Give rewards that must be used in-app:

Cashback/discounts that drive re-entry and purchases.



Personalize to reduce decision cost:

Favorite League Matches/Team Contests/Player Contests highlighted



Layer social & status:

streak badges, winner showcases, shareable moments.



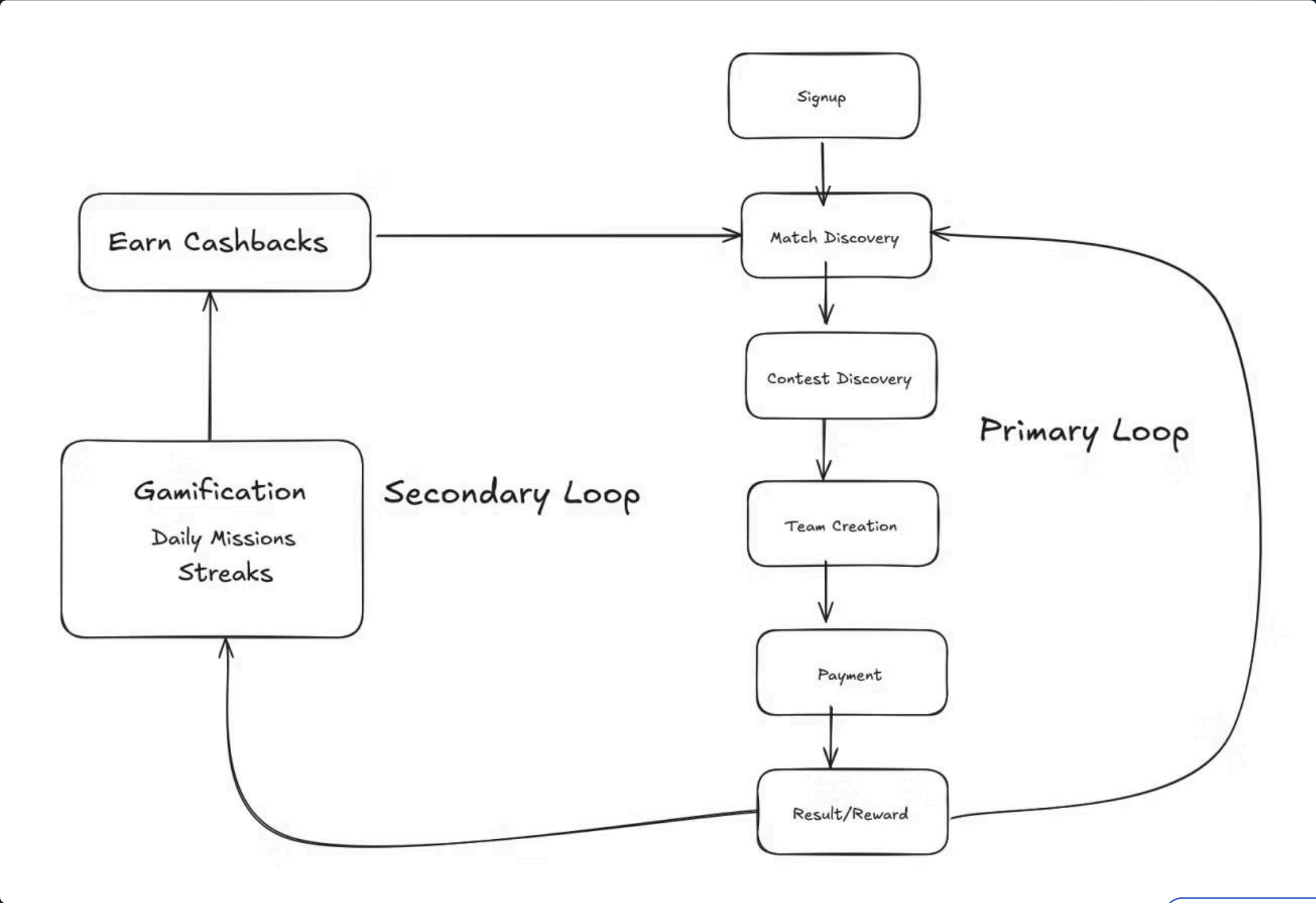
Less Friction

Team templates, less steps required to create teams



Measure & iterate rapidly:

A/B tests via remote config plus tight instrumentation.



Feature List

1) Streak-Based Rewards & Progression System

Feature Overview:

A comprehensive daily engagement system that rewards consistent participation through escalating benefits and gamified progression mechanics. Daily consecutive participation streaks (simple participation, not winning); increasing rewards + profile badges. Miss one day → reset.

Tiers & rewards (examples):

- 3-day: Re 1 discount on ₹5 contests
- 5-day: 10% cashback on ₹100 recharge
- 7-day: ₹2 discount on ₹10 contests
- 15, 21, 30, 45, 60, 90: escalating value & exclusive badges/emotes

UX:

- Streak progress bar in header and on contest cards: "Next reward in X days"
- Passive reminders: push + in-app banners for streak continuation
- Visual badges on profile and contest cards (e.g., "5-day streak" ribbon)

Success Metric(s):

- **Day 7 retention lift:** Percentage increase in users who return after 7 days of their first contest compared to baseline.
- **% of active users with 3+ and 7+ day streaks:** Measures actual habit formation and repeat engagement.
- **Contest participation rate among streak users:** Average contests per day for users with active streaks.

2) Gamification & Mission System

Overview:

4 simple missions reset every 24 hours. Completing all → 10% cashback on min ₹100 recharge. Display progress everywhere.

Mission Categories:

- **Consistency Rewards:** Daily play, streak maintenance, regular participation
- **Skill-Based Recognition:** Number of wins, top 3-n finishes, head-to-head contests won
- **Social Achievements:** Friend referrals, circle leadership, community contribution
- **Discovery Badges:** Trying new formats, using different features, and learning completion

Missions (example):

- Play 1 contest of ₹5 (low ticket)
- Play 1 paid contest of selected marquee match (e.g., today's T20)
- Play 1 contest for selected sport (if multiple sports supported)
- Invite 1 friend (or follow X influencer/share)
- Create 1 contest
- Play a 1-head-to-head contest

UX:

- Progress bar + CTA: "3 missions to get 10% cashback" shown on results screen, homepage banner, and contest cards.
- Modal on app open if missions near completion: "1 mission away: Play this contest to get cashback."
- Result screen ALWAYS shows mission status (win or loss).

Success Metric(s):

- **Day 2 return rate for users shown missions on results screen:** Direct impact of feature at the “churn moment.”
- **% of users completing all daily missions:** Shows engagement with feature; ideally >30% for habit loop effect.
- **Average number of missions completed per user per week:** Indicates sustained multi-day engagement.

3) Team Template (reduce time to create teams)

Create 4–5 templates using simple, interpretable rules:

1. Safe (High consensus, low-risk)

- Pick top players by **selection%** first (descending) until roster filled.
- Ensure credits $\leq$ `budget_threshold` (e.g., 95% of max credits).
- Prefer players with `selection%` > 40% and `avg_points` > baseline.

2. Balanced (Mix of consensus + upside)

- 60% picks by `selection%` (top-tier players)
- 40% picks by high **expected points** but moderate `selection%` (10–40%)
- Credits $\approx$ 100% budget usage.

3. Aggro (High upside, higher risk)

- Prioritize **expected points** (descending), ignoring low `selection%` until top N slots filled.
- Allow higher credits usage (e.g., 105% of average template budget if allowed).
- Prefer differential picks (`selection%` < 15%) with high recent form.

4. Role-focused

- E.g., "Bowling-heavy" for pitch favoring bowlers — use role-weighted expected points.

Success Metric(s):

- Time to contest join:** Median time from app open to contest join should decrease (target: <2min for template users).
- Team abandonment rate:** Percentage of players who drop off during team creation process.
- First contest conversion rate:** Increase in % of new users who join a contest after signing up.

4) Personalization (reduce decision cost)

- Data points stored:** favorite sport, favorite tournament, favorite team, favorite player, preferred payment method
- Notifications based on the above example: Your favorite team Chelsea, is playing today. Join to win an iPhone vs " Chelsea vs ManU today, join to win an iPhone

Success Metric(s):

- Push notification click-through rate (CTR):** For personalized vs. non-personalized nudges (target: $\geq$ 25% uplift).
- Contest join rate after personalized suggest:** % of sessions where a personalized suggestion is accepted.
- Repeat session rate for users with personalized recommendations:** Should show $\geq$ 20% improvement.

5) Lightweight gamified profile (status)

- Badges, streak levels, cashback leaderboards.
- Visual identity improves habit shows on the contest list as "Top 10% players with streak > 7 days".

Success Metric(s):

- Profile badge unlock rate:** % of users unlocking first and subsequent badges.
- Share action rate:** % of users sharing their badge/status (target: viral loop).
- Average days retained by “badge earners” vs non-badge users.**

6) Social & community feature

- Turn one-off players into social loops - competition + collective rewards make returning social and habitual.
- Clubs (create/join) with weekly leaderboards (count paid contests, points) winning club gets platform discount/pool
- Invite & club referral flow (track invite attribution)
- Club activity feed
- Club admin tools (invite limits, discount budgets, member caps)

Success Metric(s):

- % of active users in a club or with at least 1 social connection in-app.**
- Contests per club member per week:** Shows lift in contest frequency from social mechanics.
- Club leaderboard visibility rate:** % of club users who check leaderboard at least once per week.

7) Rewarded video for extra entries

- While unconventional, but a hit for free-to-play games, this can be a great option to introduce for casual users who are ready to watch video ads for small rewards. Small entry fee contests or Streak continuance can be rewarded after considering the economy and limits

Success Metric(s):

- Video ad completion rate:** % of prompted users completing video to get retry or streak protection (target: >40%).
- Retry entry conversion:** % of users who play an extra contest immediately after watching a video.
- Lift in daily active players attributed to rewarded video.**

8) AI summaries

- Use short, human-readable bullets (no heavy stats). Example:
- Form: "Team A won 4 of the last 5 T20s"
- Pitch effect: "Pitch favors pacers"
- Key player: "Player X likely to bat top 3"
- Captain pick: "Choose Y high scoring expectation"
- Game-note: "Light rain expected; over reduction possible"
- There are a lot of stats already per match, a casual player will not read through everything and would love a summarized version of the same

Success Metric(s):

- Usage rate of AI summary feature:** % of casual users who click/open summaries when building teams.
- Time spent on “team build” for users using summaries:** Should drop by at least 30% vs. those who don’t use summary.
- Accuracy/confidence improvement perception (pulse survey):** % of users who report feeling more confident about their picks.

Prioritization of Features

RICE table (numbers & reason)

Legend: Reach (0–10), Impact (0–10), Confidence (0–10), Effort (person-weeks: S=2, M=4, L=8)

RICE = (Reach × Impact × Confidence) / Effort

Feature	R	I	C	Effort (wks)	RICE	Priority	Quick reason
1 Gamification & Mission System (result-screen always shows mission status; completing all → cashback)	9	9	8	4 (M)	162	Po	Directly shown on the Results screen, gives immediate call-to-action to re-enter; high reach for casuals; quick to instrument.
2 Streak-Based Rewards & Progression (streak progress at header- result nudges)	9	8	7	4 (M)	126	Po	Strong habit-former tied to daily return; visible at results screen; deep retention lever.
3 Team Templates (Safe/Balanced/Aggro etc. — reduce time-to-team)	8	6	8	4 (M)	96	Po	Helps speed up team creation and reduces cognitive friction earlier in the funnel → increases conversion to contests, which reduces downstream drop at results.
4 Personalization (fav sport/tour/payment rails)	7	7	6	3 (S→M)	98	Po / P1	Helps targeting and nudges for result→replay messaging; useful but less direct than mission/streak.
5 Lightweight Gamified Profile (status, badges)	6	5	6	4 (M)	90	P1	Social/status nudge visible on result & contest cards; supports habit formation.
6 Rewarded Video for Extra Entries (watch at result for extra entry/streak protection)	7	7	2	2 (S)	98	P1	Very low effort, high immediacy at results stage; incentivises retry instead of churn-but needs economy guardrails.
7 AI Summaries (5-point match tips)	8	5	6	4 (M)	60	P2	Supports decision confidence and team quality but impacts retention indirectly; higher engineering/data cost.
8 Social & Community (Clubs, leaderboards)	6	7	5	8 (L)	26.2 5	P3	High potential but large effort and slower payback

Short explanation of ordering

- **Missions** are highest because they *live on the results screen* always (your stated choke point). They turn a loss or payout moment into an immediate "task to complete" and a reason to stay/return (cashback as reward). They directly convert reactive churn into another action.
- **Streaks** are the classic habit lever. Showing streak progress on result cards + in header creates FOMO of losing a streak after a missed day — that's perfect to counteract the "I lost signup cash, I'm done" thought.
- **Team templates** speed up the upstream flow (team creation) and reduce drop-off before contest pay — indirectly reducing the number of people reaching Results and quitting. This is high ROI but less direct than missions/streaks.
- **Personalization** is low effort, customized notifications based on user preferences. This will give a personal/custom touch to the messaging to the users, who will feel connected to the app
- **Rewarded video** is a low-effort win: as a result, we give a small micro-opportunity to continue- immediately re-engage. This needs strong economy guardrails (caps, frequency limits) so it doesn't cannibalise paid conversions.
- **Lightweight profile, AI summaries** round out the product to increase long-term stickiness and conversion, but they either cost more or act upstream. They are P1/P2.
- **Social & Clubs** are powerful but large bets- which can be built later when the base daily habit has improved.

30-Day User Journey

Stage (timing)	What the user sees	Feature(s) activated	What motivates return	User feels	Why it delights
Day 0 – Signup & First Play	Short FTUE → Welcome bonus banner → Team Templates (Safe/Balanced) on team screen → Quick-Join CTA	Team Templates + Personalization (simple time-of-day suggestion)	Low-effort entry + instant bonus; templates cut decision time so they can join quickly	Curious, relieved - “that was easy”	Fast path to play; immediate value (bonus) and confidence from pre-built teams
Result Moment (immediate post-game, Do)	Result screen shows mission progress (e.g., 1/3), streak starter indicator, “Play again” CTA	Missions + Streak starter	Clear next micro-goal (complete missions) and start a streak	Encouraged or annoyed (if lost) but given a clear next action	Loss becomes an action: a simple next step and short-term reward to chase
D1-D3 – Early Repeat	Persistent mission progress bar on home/result; push nudge at their play hour; template suggested for faster team build	Missions + Team Templates + Personalization (timed nudges)	Desire to complete daily missions and avoid breaking a growing streak	Motivated, goal-oriented	Visible progress and low-friction actions make repeating simple and satisfying
D4-D7 – Habit Forming	Streak progress visible in header + on contest cards; first small streak reward (e.g., Re1 discount) appears on result/profile	Streaks + Missions + Templates	Fear of losing streak + tangible micro-rewards (discounts/cashback)	Proud when progressing, loss-averse when close to breaking	Earned micro-rewards and visible streak meter create a habit loop and pride
D8-D14 – Consolidation	Gamified profile shows earned badges; templates expand (Aggro option appears); personalization suggests contests matching historic behaviour	Team Templates + Personalization + Streak visibility	Status (badges) + quicker team builds + tailored contest suggestions	Confident, more invested	Recognition + better-fit recommendations make the app feel smarter and more rewarding
D15-D30 – Retain & Scale	Higher-tier streak previews (bigger rewards), mission calendar reminders, personalized weekend match highlights	Missions (calendar) + Streak ladder + Templates + Personalization	Longer-term streak incentives + personalized high-value contests and easier team creation	Committed, habitual; perceives value in staying daily	Escalating, personalized rewards turn short-term habits into ongoing routines and habit identity

Macros Deliverables:

Why users will tap *our* notification (vs Dream11/my11)

- **Hyper-personalized & timely** notifications reference their favourite team/player and send at their usual play time.
- **One-tap, high-value action** notification opens to a Quick-Join with a Team Template and saved payment method.
- **Contextual incentive at the moment of loss** result-screen CTAs ("1 mission away for 10% cashback" / "watch to protect streak") convert frustration into immediate action.

Why our app becomes their preferred fantasy app

- **Multiple immediate delights** at the result: missions, streaks, rewarded retries losses turn into chances to win or earn.
- **Friction removed**: Team Templates cut team creation to seconds, ideal for casual commuters.
- **Personalized cadence**: contest suggestions, nudges and offers match the user's behavior and preferred time, increasing relevance.
- **Trust & measurability**: clear reward mechanics, guarded economy, and rapid A/B testing ensure scalable wins.